



American University of Beirut
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Beirut, Lebanon

CONSENT TO SERVE AS A PARTICIPANT IN A RESEARCH PROJECT

Project title: The Effect of Reading Direction on Face Perception

Department: Psychology

Principal Investigator: Zahra Hussain, PhD

Co-Investigator: Riwa Safa

This form documents your consent to participate in the following study conducted at the department of psychology, AUB. Please read the information below and feel free to ask any questions that you may have. To participate in this study, you must be over 18 years of age, with normal or corrected-to-normal vision.

Nature and purpose of the project

The aim of this project is to investigate the mechanisms underlying face perception. We are interested in knowing how observers determine face identity. This will be measured by asking subjects to say which of two faces matches a target face, and by examining which parts of the face subjects use when they are making this decision. Furthermore, we will investigate whether face perception differs between English (or other European language) readers, Arabic readers, and bilingual readers of both languages.

Sample and recruitment

The sample will comprise approximately 150 individuals between the ages of 18-65 years, with normal or corrected-to-normal vision, i.e., visual acuity of 20/40 or better on the ETDRS chart after glasses are worn, and no history of cataracts, glaucoma, macular degeneration, or other visual impairment. Participants will span a range of proficiency in English and Arabic and must be able to read in at least one of the two languages. Both native English and Arabic readers will be recruited. Subjects will comprise members of the public recruited online through social media, emails, and word of mouth. Subjects will also comprise undergraduate students taking Psyc 101/201 course at the Department of Psychology at AUB, recruited via personal communication and coordination with student subject pools (e.g., PSYC 101 and 201) in accordance with departmental and institutional regulations.

Procedure

In this experiment, you will perform a computer-based visual task online, lasting about 30 to 40 minutes. Your proficiency will be assessed using the Language Proficiency Questionnaire and you will fill the Edinburgh Handedness Inventory Short Form to assess for handedness. You will also be asked to read a text in your most proficient language to assess for reading speed. To make sure you have read the text, you will answer four multiple choice questions. During the visual task, you will be presented with three faces in a row simultaneously and asked to make a decision about which of the two faces presented on the left or the right looks the most similar to the face presented in the center. You will respond by pressing specific keys on the keyboard. If you wish, you may take a break between trials. Our research project requires that the full purpose of the study is next explained before you participate. We will give you a full explanation once you complete the study.

*Institutional Review Board
American University of Beirut*

Compensation

01 JUL 2020